

4.5 Players

Ah. So you've tweaked everything to ensure the best audio experience, and sit back to listen to your collection, but...

It just refuses to play!

If your media player gives you an error saying "Cannot playback stream" or something to that effect, it usually means that it can't access your sound card. Check if you have other programs running that are using the sound card (such as games, other media players or sound editors), and close them.

If the problem persists, check if you have the proper codecs installed to play the file. As mentioned before, installing the K-Lite Mega Codec Pack should take care of nearly all codec problems.

You could also try VLC Media Player to play the file—it can play almost any audio format.

The music just...stops

If your audio files play a little way through and then fall silent, it means that the file is corrupt—it's probably due to an error in downloading or ripping. If you encoded the file yourself, the corruption may be due to a glitch in the encoding process. When encoding files, make sure that you close all unnecessary applications and try to do as little with your machine as possible while encoding. You'll need to download or encode the file again to fix this.

Some MP3s won't play on my portable player

Check if the MP3 is a VBR (Variable Bit-rate) or a CBR (Constant Bit-rate) encoded file. Open the file in a player such as Winamp and check the description. Some older portable music players do not have support for VBR MP3s, so you won't be able to hear them.

There is also the chance that you've had a run-in with Digital Rights Management (DRM). Music vendors program the MP3 with limitations in an attempt to curb piracy. One of these measures is pre-